



Mercedes-Benz

Press Information

July 31, 2025

793 Raids in 2024: Over 1.5 million Mercedes-Benz counterfeit products seized worldwide

- **49% increase in 2024:** over 212,000 counterfeit product listings removed from social media and online platforms
- **793 Raids:** globally, more than two raids daily conducted by trade supervisory and law enforcement agencies targeting Mercedes-Benz counterfeits
- **Mercedes-Benz Brand Protection Team:** primarily combats safety-relevant counterfeits and continues to expand activities

Stuttgart. At first glance, they are often hard to distinguish, yet counterfeit products pose significant risks to millions of road users and cause immense economic damage. Therefore, Mercedes-Benz collaborates closely with customs, trade supervisory, and law enforcement authorities worldwide to combat counterfeits. The brand protectors focus particularly on safety-relevant counterfeits: these do not meet the high safety and quality standards of Mercedes-Benz and can lead to severe accidents. Items such as air filters made from highly flammable materials, inferior brake components, and brake pads containing hazardous materials like lead and arsenic have been seized during raids. In 2024 alone, authorities secured more than 1.5 million Mercedes-Benz counterfeit products in 793 raids and with the help of customs worldwide — an upward trend.

“Originals stand for tested quality. They meet technical, environmental, and occupational safety requirements, ensuring road safety. Therefore, we work closely with authorities to prevent the spread of counterfeits. Through our extensive fight against the counterfeit industry, we protect road users from serious accidents, safeguard customers from deception, and strengthen trust in our brand.”

Renata Jungo Brüngger, Member of the Board of Management of Mercedes-Benz Group AG for Integrity, Governance & Sustainability

Particularly, raids conducted with authorities worldwide are a crucial measure in the fight against dangerous product counterfeiting. These are often preceded by months of intensive investigations and preparations. The brand protectors at Mercedes-Benz scrutinize offers on websites, follow up on counterfeit leads, and conduct thorough research to ultimately identify the counterfeiters' production sites. The goal is to prevent the distribution of counterfeits. The investigation results are provided to the authorities responsible for conducting the raids. These authorities search the counterfeiters' workshops, where often catastrophic working conditions prevail and serious environmental damage is caused.

Mercedes-Benz Group AG | Mercedesstrasse 120, 70372 Stuttgart | T +49 711 17-0 | dialog@mercedes-benz.com | group.mercedes-benz.com

Mercedes-Benz Group AG | Headquarters: Stuttgart | Register court: Stuttgart Local Court | HRB no: 19360

Chairman of the Supervisory Board: Martin Brudermüller

Board of Management: Ola Källenius, Chairman; Jörg Burzer, Mathias Geisen, Renata Jungo Brüngger, Markus Schäfer, Britta Seeger, Oliver Thöne, Hubertus Troska, Harald Wilhelm

A notable observation by the Mercedes-Benz Brand Protection Team is that increasingly premium high-end brand products, such as those from Mercedes-Benz Maybach and AMG, are being counterfeited. This includes the modification of Mercedes vehicles in violation of intellectual property rights and even recreating entire vehicles. The brand protection team at Mercedes-Benz takes consistently action against such infringing replicas and modifications.

Additionally, counterfeiting networks continue to use online platforms and social media to widely distribute counterfeit products. They benefit from the extensive anonymity and decentralized structure of these marketplaces and technologies, as well as the fast-paced nature of social media. This is why Mercedes-Benz has been intensifying its strategic and operational measures against counterfeiting for years, particularly also in the online environment. In 2024, the brand protectors deleted over 212,000 listings of counterfeit Mercedes-Benz products and trademark-infringing content.

Collaboration with authorities is one of the success factors of the Brand Protection Team. Therefore, the brand protectors regularly support customs authorities and service providers with training sessions and informational materials for awareness and prevention.

What should be considered to avoid falling for counterfeit products?

A few simple purchasing criteria can help consumers avoid buying counterfeit products. The first step is to carefully examine suspicious offers in everyday (online) shopping. Typical warning signs of counterfeits include a significantly lower price, noticeable defects in product quality, or sales through questionable (online) sources. Sometimes, you can already tell from the product images or names that they cannot be originals, especially if Mercedes-Benz does not manufacture these products.

Contacts:

Marco Löhner, +49 176 3090 2698, marco.loehner@mercedes-benz.com

Silke Mockert, +49 160 867 2007, silke.mockert@mercedes-benz.com

Further information about **Mercedes-Benz** is available at www.mercedes-benz.com and on our **LinkedIn channel** under [Mercedes-Benz AG | LinkedIn](#). Press information and digital services for journalists and multipliers can be found on our **Mercedes-Benz Media online platform** at media.mercedes-benz.com.

Forward-looking statements

This document contains forward-looking statements that reflect our current views about future events. The words “anticipate”, “assume”, “believe”, “estimate”, “expect”, “intend”, “may”, “can”, “could”, “plan”, “project”, “should” and similar expressions are used to identify forward-looking statements. These statements are subject to many risks and uncertainties, including an adverse development of global economic conditions, in particular a negative change in market conditions in our most important markets; a deterioration of our refinancing possibilities on the credit and financial markets; events of force majeure including natural disasters, pandemics, acts of terrorism, political unrest, armed conflicts, industrial accidents and their effects on our sales, purchasing, production or financial services activities; changes in currency exchange rates, customs and foreign trade provisions; changes in laws, regulations and government policies (or changes in their interpretation), particularly those relating to vehicle emissions, fuel economy and safety or to the communication regarding sustainability topics (environmental, social or governance topics); price increases for fuel, raw materials or energy; disruption of production due to shortages of materials or energy, labour strikes or supplier insolvencies; a shift in consumer preferences towards smaller, lower-margin vehicles; a limited demand for all-electric vehicles; a possible lack of acceptance of our products or services which limits our ability to achieve prices and adequately utilize our production capacities; a decline in resale prices of used vehicles; the effective implementation of cost-reduction and efficiency-optimization measures; the business outlook for companies in which we hold a significant equity interest; the successful implementation of strategic cooperations and joint ventures; the resolution of pending governmental investigations or of investigations requested by governments and the outcome of pending or threatened future legal proceedings; and other risks and uncertainties, some of which are described under the heading “Risk and Opportunity Report” in the current Annual Report or in the current Interim Report. If any of these risks and uncertainties materialises or if the assumptions underlying any of our forward-looking statements prove to be incorrect, the actual results may be materially different from those we express or imply by such statements. We do not intend or assume any obligation to update these forward-looking statements since they are based solely on the circumstances at the date of publication.

Mercedes-Benz Group at a glance

Mercedes-Benz Group AG is one of the world's most successful automotive companies. With Mercedes-Benz AG, the Group is one of the leading global suppliers of high-end passenger cars and premium vans. Mercedes-Benz Mobility AG specialises in financial and mobility services. The products range from financing, leasing, vehicle subscription, rental and fleet management to insurance, innovative mobility services, digital payment solutions as well as products and services around charging. The company founders, Gottlieb Daimler and Carl Benz, made history by inventing the automobile in 1886. As a pioneer of automotive engineering, Mercedes-Benz sees shaping the future of mobility in a safe and sustainable way as both a motivation and obligation. The company's focus therefore remains on innovative and green technologies as well as on safe and superior vehicles that both captivate and inspire. Mercedes-Benz continues to invest systematically in the development of efficient powertrains and sets the course for an all-electric future. Mercedes-Benz is consistently implementing its strategy to transform itself toward a fully electric and software-driven future. The company's efforts are also focused on the intelligent connectivity of its vehicles, autonomous driving and new mobility concepts as Mercedes-Benz regards it as its aspiration and obligation to live up to its responsibility to society and the environment. Mercedes-Benz sells its vehicles and services in nearly every country of the world and has production facilities in Europe, North and Latin America, Asia and Africa. In addition to Mercedes-Benz, the world's most valuable luxury automotive brand (source: Interbrand study, 10. Oct. 2024), Mercedes-AMG, Mercedes-Maybach as well as the brands of Mercedes-Benz Mobility: Mercedes-Benz Bank, Mercedes-Benz Financial Services and Athlon. The company is listed on the Frankfurt and Stuttgart stock exchanges (ticker symbol MBG). In 2024, the Group had a workforce of around 175,000 and sold around 2.4 million vehicles. Group revenues amounted to €145.6 billion and Group EBIT to €13.6 billion.